

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	ENGL1A28
Subject Title	Effective Communication for Emerging Professionals
Credit Value	3
Level	1
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Exclusion: ENGL2A10, ENGL1A25 [Remarks: ENGL students may take this subject.]
Objectives	This subject emphasizes the development of practical workplace communication strategies that are well-grounded in scholarship and tailored to individual needs. It aims to use language and communication as a cornerstone to investigate how individuals make sense of the world in which they live and work, how they acquire knowledge, the biases they bring to this knowledge, and the role of each person's unique sociohistorical contexts in their understanding of reality. The subject highlights communication theory to unpack issues related to intercultural diversity, workplace hierarchies, and new technologies. It helps all students entering the professional workforce and, irrespective of their chosen professions, provides them with the essential skills to cultivate healthy workplace relationships. Specifically: • Students will be introduced to a framework that illuminates the relationship between identity, social context, and effective interpersonal communication skills. • Students will take part in highly engaging, hands-on activities to apply the theory learned in lectures to everyday scenarios and experiences. • Students will gain insights into the effective use of communication skills to unlock interpersonal conflict in the workplace other contexts. • Given the multicultural nature of the modern workplace, students will reflect on the complexities of intercultural communication in organizational and personal relationships. • Students will learn theory-informed approaches to technologically mediated communication, enabling them to adapt and thrive in the online workspace. • To consolidate learnings, students will examine research in specific organizational settings such as, but not limited to, hotel communication,

	caregiver-patient interaction, business negotiations, and product development teams.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: - Develop awareness of the motivations and cognitions that influence human behaviour; - Critically appraise communication and social psychology theory that explains aspects of human behaviour; - Effectively evaluate workplace and other situations where highly developed communication skills are essential for successful outcomes; - Manage diverse group and team situations to achieve required key performance indicators; - Attain improved communication skills for use in difficult workplace situations as well as day-to-day living; - Understand the psychological mechanisms that explain how the “self” seeks to impress on others and how the “self” perceives others; - Acquire a good understanding of communication with diverse populations (intercultural, cross cultural, and minority groups); and - Fulfill the CAR reading and writing requirements in English.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	What is professional communication? - Defining what communication is - How communication theory describes conveying messages verbally and non-verbally from a sender to a receiver in the simple transmission model - How different communication theories explain communication and perceptions - Applying this knowledge to professional practice. Tasks and verbal and non-verbal communication - Defining non-verbal communication - Classification of non-verbal behavior (e.g., Kinesics, Proxemics, Chronemics, Haptics, and Vocalics) - Relative importance of non-verbal and verbal communication, and how context matters - The power of verbal communication - Bringing verbal and non-verbal communication together Working and communicating in groups - Groups and teams – how they differ - Group and team formation - Group dynamics and the role of individuals in groups and teams - How to create and manage effective groups and teams in professional practice Conflict resolution, management skills, and workplace relationships - A model of conflict and the associated stages and responses to conflict - Adapting different conflict management styles according to the situations faced

[illegible]

	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: In-class group presentations enable students to learn how to work together and practice spoken communication in English. The presentation will require that students create a short video clip to demonstrate some aspect of miscommunication. They will also need to conduct a small literature review to support their presentations. The presentation will be 15 minutes. The readings form 5% of the ER requirement. For presentations to be successful, students must research additional readings that will inform the presentation and reflect extended learning beyond the recommended texts. Role-plays and other active learning approaches will be used to help students develop essential and personalized communication skills. Concise and clear articulation of what each student has learnt throughout the subject will be achieved through the written assignment. This will be in the form of an academic reflective essay (1500-2500 words) and will serve as the EW component of the subject. The essay will be developed over two drafts, the first of which will be in the form of a planning template and responses to guiding questions. The multiple-choice test assesses the broad range of information provided in the class. It is designed to be comprehensive in scope, covering both the lecture and reading content. Students can only answer the multiple-choice questions successfully upon completion of a comprehensive reading of the required texts. Students must obtain a D or above on both the written assessment and multiple-choice test to pass the course.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures (13 x 2 hours)	26 Hrs.
	▪ Seminars/Tutorials (1 x 13 hours)	13 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Individual and Group Study	26 Hrs.
	▪ Written Assignment	26 Hrs.
	▪ Private Study	26 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	117 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Required Readings (237 pp.) Archee, R. & Gurney, M. (2024). <i>Communicating as professionals</i> (4th ed.). Cengage Publishing Chapters taken from this text are as follows: Chapter 1: Communication theory and professional practice (30pp) Chapter 3: Non-verbal communication: Meanings without words (28pp) Chapter 8: Concepts and applications in interpersonal communication (37pp)	

Chapter 9: Communicating in teams to achieve professional goals: group dynamics and negotiation (32pp)

Carr, C. T. (2021). *Computer-mediated communication: A theoretical and practical introduction to online human communication*. Rowman & Littlefield.

Chapter taken from this text is as follows:

Chapter 1: What is computer mediated communication? (11 pp)

Vine, B. (2020). *Introducing language in the workplace*. Cambridge University Press.

Chapter taken from this text is as follows:

Chapter 8: Intercultural communication (25 pp)

Wood, J. (2020). *Interpersonal communication: Everyday encounters* (9th ed.). Cengage Publishing

Chapters taken from this text are as follows:

Chapter 6: Mindful Listening (23 pp)

Chapter 8: Communication Climate: The Foundation of Personal Relationships (23 pp)

Chapter 9: Managing Conflict in Relationships (28 pp)

Further readings

Aharon, T., & Lily, C.-H. (2012). Perspectives on groups and work teams in the workplace. *Journal of Work and Organizational Psychology*, 28(1), 51-66. doi:10.5093/tr2012a5

Allison, S., & Herlocker, C. (1994). Constructing impressions in demographically diverse organizational settings: A group categorization analysis. *The American Behavioral Scientist* (1986-1994), 37(5), 637. doi:10.1177/0002764294037005005

Angouri, J. (2014). Multilingualism in the workplace: Language practices in multilingual contexts. *Multilingua*, 33(1), 1-9. doi:10.1515/multi-2014-0001

Derek, H. (2016). *Workplace discrimination*. Wisconsin Law Journal.

Fox, S., & Lituchy, T. R. (2012). *Gender and the dysfunctional workplace*. Edward Elgar.

Hogg, M. A., Van Knippenberg, D., & Rast, I. D. E. (2012). Intergroup leadership in organizations: Leading across group and organizational boundaries. *Academy of Management Review*, 37(2), 232-255. doi:10.5465/amr.2010.0221

Mayfield, J., & Mayfield, M. (2017). Leadership communication. *International Journal of Business Communication*, 54(1), 3-11. doi:10.1177/2329488416675446

Patterson, M. L. (2012). *Nonverbal communication*. Elsevier.

Richardson, B., Taylor, P., Snook, B., Conchie, S. M., & Bennell, C. (2014). Language style matching and police interrogation outcomes. *Law and Human Behavior*, 38(4), 357-366. doi:10.1037/lhb0000077

Sánchez-Vidal, M. A. E., Cegarra-Leiva, D., & Cegarra-Navarro, J. G. (2012). Gaps between managers' and employees' perceptions of work-life balance. *The International Journal of Human Resource Management*, 23(4), 645-661. doi:10.1080/09585192.2011.561219

- Simon, E. (2016). Variety of skills, traits combine to create a good leader. *Hotel Management*, 231(10), 48.
- Sterling, E., Bravo, A., Porzecanski, A. L., Burks, R. L., Linder, J., Langen, T., Fernandez, D., Ruby, D., & Bynum, N. (2016). Think before (and after) you speak: Practice and self-reflection bolster oral communication skills. *Journal of College Science Teaching*, 45(6), 87.
- Ting-Toomey, S. (2010). Applying dimensional values in understanding intercultural communication. *Communication Monographs*, 77(2), 169-180. doi:10.1080/03637751003790428
- Ying Liao, Y., Soltani, E., Wang, W.-Y., & Iqbal, A. (2016). The dynamics of workplace relationships in a diverse internationally staffed organisation: A qualitative ethnographic assessment. *The International Journal of Human Resource Management*, 1-30. doi:10.1080/09585192.2016.1166788
- Zeidner, M., & Kloda, I. (2013). Emotional intelligence (EI), conflict resolution patterns, and relationship satisfaction: Actor and partner effects revisited. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 54(2), 278-283. doi:10.1016/j.paid.2012.09.013

Revised by Tobias Lee, May 2026